

C-Suite Objection Defense Dossier

Boardroom Red-Team Simulation — MDR Devices Pitch

CEO

Growth, cost management, operational transparency; low tolerance for architectural detail unless mapped to risk or revenue.

CIO

System stability, custom-code exposure, upgrade risk, missing departmental requirements, validation rigor.

MUCH. CONSULTING LEAD PARTNER

Technical depth, executive presence, composure under pressure.

Part I — The Original Twelve, Corrected Where Verification Demanded It

1 · CIO — UPGRADE PATH RISK

“A 90-day hold plus this much automation — what happens to our upgrade path when Odoo ships a new major version?”

REBUTTAL

“The core of this — credential gating, quarantine automation, the analytic spine — is Studio configuration, not custom code, and that carries forward across major versions far more reliably than a bespoke module would. I won't tell you it's zero-risk; Odoo's own upgrade process expects a configuration review on complex automated rules, and we budget for that review every release. The pieces that go beyond native configuration — the five named extension items — are scoped deliberately small and validated on their own track precisely so they don't inflate your overall upgrade risk. That's a smaller, more honest number than 'zero custom code,' and it's the one I'd stand behind in an audit.”

2 · CEO — TIME TO VALUE

“How long before I actually see this transparency you're describing, not just on a slide?”

REBUTTAL

“Sales and Quality configuration — the credential gate and the quarantine automation — are live in a testable instance within the first sprint. You'll see real data moving through the first thread segment inside weeks, not at the end of a year-long build. Full end-to-end transparency scales as each subsequent module comes online, but you're not waiting for a big-bang go-live to see value.”

3 · CIO — DEPARTMENTAL RESISTANCE

“Departments have run on siloed tools for years. What makes you think Sales or Logistics won't resist a system that suddenly blocks their orders?”

REBUTTAL

“The credential block isn't a new rule we're inventing — it's the rule they already operate under informally today, just enforced consistently instead of depending on someone remembering to check. We involve each department in defining the exact block conditions during configuration, so it lands as 'the system finally does what we always meant to do,' not as a new obstacle imposed on them.”

4 · LEAD PARTNER — ELECTRONIC SIGNATURE GAP

“Walk me through what happens if the electronic signature requirement under Annex 11 isn't fully native in Odoo — isn't that a gap in your architecture?”

REBUTTAL

“It's a known platform boundary, not an oversight — and I'd be more concerned if I told you Odoo handled dual-authentication e-signatures natively out of the box, because it doesn't, and claiming otherwise wouldn't survive a validation audit. It's the same pattern we've addressed on other regulated device work: a two-step release gate — quality check pass plus a separately permissioned re-authentication — using native permission and activity models. One precision worth having ready: Annex 11 itself is EU GMP, EudraLex Volume 4 — we apply it, alongside 21 CFR Part 11 and ISO 13485, as the accepted GxP benchmark for computerised systems in device manufacturing. That's a validated, defensible, previously-proven design decision, and I'd rather present it that way than oversell a feature that isn't there.”

5A · CIO — REUSABLE INSTRUMENTS AREN'T IMPLANTS

“Your whole architecture reads as one-way — receive, hold, consume. My instrument trays don't get consumed, they come back dirty and go through sterilization fifty times before I retire them. Where's that in this design?”

REBUTTAL

“You're right to draw that line, and it's a genuinely different pattern, not a variant of the implant flow — which is why we model it separately rather than forcing it through the same consumption logic. A tray dispatches the same way an implant does, but instead of a consumption event, a return move sends it to a sterilization location, a quality check gates its return to dispatch-ready stock, and a cycle counter — extension-layer, Odoo doesn't track reuse limits natively — blocks it from going out again once it hits its manufacturer-specified limit. It's an asset loop, not a sale, and treating it as one would have corrupted your consumption reporting the first time a tray came back.”

5B · CEO — WHAT HAPPENS TO STOCK THAT COMES BACK

“A surgery gets cancelled, or a hospital sends back something that's expired. What actually happens to that stock — does it just vanish from the system?”

REBUTTAL

“No — and if it did just vanish, that would be the audit finding, not the fix. It comes back into a dedicated returns quarantine, gets a quality disposition — re-release if it's genuinely still within spec, otherwise scrap or return-to-vendor — and stays tied to its original lot record the whole way through, so the traceability chain shows the return, not a gap. If it had already been billed, that disposition also decides whether a credit note goes out. Nothing about a return breaks the thread; it's just another documented state the thread accounts for.”

5C · LEAD PARTNER — GDPR, NOT JUST MDR

“You've spent this whole pitch on MDR and GxP. This CRM has patient names tied to specific implant serials. What about GDPR?”

REBUTTAL

“Fair catch, and I'd rather you hear it from me now than find it missing later. MDR/GxP and GDPR are two separate regimes running over the same data, and this package has focused on the first. Patient-linked records in the CRM are special-category health data under Article 9 — that means a documented legal basis, data minimization, and a retention policy that isn't just inherited from the MDR traceability clock, plus very likely a DPIA given the volume and sensitivity involved. I'd scope that formally with your legal and DPO function in discovery rather than design it myself from this side of the table — but I want to name it now rather than let you find the gap first.”

5D · CIO — STERILIZATION DATA INTEGRITY

“Your cycle-count block is structural, fine. But what stops a tech from just recording a pass on the autoclave check that didn't actually happen? The system can't see inside the sterilizer.”

REBUTTAL

“You're right, and I won't pretend a system field can verify physical reality — no ERP can. What it can do is make sure one person's false entry isn't sufficient on its own. Redeployment sits behind the same two-step release gate as the quarantine hold: a second, independently authenticated reviewer countersigns before a tray goes back into rotation. That doesn't make data entry error-proof. It means a single point of failure — one tech, one mistake or one shortcut — can't put an improperly sterilized kit back into a hospital by itself.”

5E · CEO — WHO EATS THE COST OF A RETURN

“When a hospital sends back an implant they say is defective and we say was mishandled — who actually pays for that, and does your system decide?”

REBUTTAL

“The system doesn't decide who pays — that's a contract question, and it shouldn't be a field in Odoo pretending to answer it. What the system does is give you the record to have that conversation from a position of strength: disposition, condition on return, and full chain of custody, all tied to the same lot. Whatever your consignment agreement says about defective-return liability, you're negotiating from documented fact instead of a hospital's word against yours.”

5F · CIO — WHAT HAPPENS MID-CUTOVER

“Say a complaint comes in during the parallel-run window, against a device that's already migrated to the new system. Which system does that complaint live in?”

REBUTTAL

“The new system, every time, once a device has migrated — we don't reopen the legacy system for anything new once cutover starts for that record. The legacy system stays live only for records that were already open before cutover, until they close. That's a hard rule, not a case-by-case judgment call, precisely so nobody has to guess which system is authoritative mid-transition.”

5G · LEAD PARTNER — PROVE THE COMPARABLE ENGAGEMENTS ARE REAL

“You've referenced 'comparable regulated-device engagements' three times in this pitch. Name one. Can I call them?”

REBUTTAL

“That's a fair challenge, and I'd rather answer it directly than hide behind the phrase again. I'm not going to name a client in this room without their consent to be referenced — doing that casually would be its own red flag about how we handle confidentiality, and it should read that way to you. What I will commit to: reference calls, with client permission, as a condition of moving into the engagement — not a vague promise, an actual step in the discovery-phase plan. If that's not something we can deliver, that itself is information you should have before signing.”

5 · CEO — ROI SCOPE

“This all sounds like a lot of upfront investment for a fairly narrow product line. Where's the payback?”

REBUTTAL

“The payback isn't isolated to implants — it's the audit exposure and rework cost you're carrying today across every regulated product line, compounding every time a new tool gets bolted on. On comparable engagements, audit-evidence compilation has gone from weeks of manual assembly to a same-day export — I'd want to size that figure for MDR Devices specifically during discovery rather than promise it today, but the pattern holds. Once this thread exists for implants, extending it to instrument kits or future product lines is configuration, not a rebuild. You're not buying a point solution — you're buying the pattern once.”

Part II — Eight New Objections From the Round 5 Independent Audit

These emerged from a fresh red-team pass by an independent reviewer — none were covered by Part I. Objection 6 corrects a line from an earlier prep round that would have failed under challenge.

6 · CEO — WHICH REGULATION SAYS 90 DAYS?

“You keep calling the three-month hold mandatory. Which regulation actually says 90 days?”

REBUTTAL — CORRECTED; AN EARLIER DRAFT CALLED THIS “A REGULATORY FLOOR,” WHICH WOULD NOT SURVIVE THIS QUESTION

“None does, directly — and I'd rather say that plainly than invent a citation. The three-month hold is your own quality policy as described in the brief, and there are usually good reasons behind such a policy — supplier qualification evidence, sterility assurance, contractual terms. We treat it as a hard constraint and enforce it structurally, exactly as if it were regulation, because from an audit perspective your own documented quality policy is binding on you. In discovery we'd confirm the actual driver behind the ninety days — and whether the brief's phrasing also implies a three-month coverage trigger on replenishment — so the configured rule reflects the real requirement rather than a number inherited by habit.”

7 · LEAD PARTNER — YOUR OWN ODOO TRACK RECORD

“You clearly know ERP. How many Odoo implementations have you personally delivered?”

REBUTTAL — HONESTY PLUS EVIDENCE; DO NOT BLUFF THIS ONE

“In production — none yet, and I won't dress that up. What I bring is three full implementation lifecycles in enterprise CRM and logistics platforms — blueprint through hypercare — and the architecture judgment that transfers directly: where to hold the native line, where to extend, how to keep a validated system validated through upgrades. And I didn't leave the Odoo depth theoretical: every load-bearing claim in this package was checked against Odoo's documentation, and the core mechanisms — the credential block, the quarantine routing — I built hands-on in a sandbox before walking in here. I'd rather show you what I verified myself than recite a tenure number.”

8 · CIO — SHOW ME THE TWO-PAYER FIELD

“You said one surgery produces an insurer invoice and a co-pay invoice. Show me the field in Odoo that makes one sale order invoice two different partners.”

REBUTTAL — THE ARCHITECTURE DOCUMENTS ALREADY STATE THIS CORRECTLY; THE ANSWER IS CONFIRMATION, NOT RETREAT

“There isn't one, and our architecture document says so in exactly those words: a sale order natively invoices a single partner. The payer split — even the simple insurer-plus-co-pay case — is one of the five named extension items. What's native is the analytic spine: every invoice the split logic generates carries the same distribution key back to the consumption event, which is what makes reconciliation structural. That's precisely why we sell named custom code rather than pretending the platform does things it doesn't.”

9 · CIO — WHICH VERSION, EXACTLY?

“Which Odoo version are you proposing we implement, and how do you decide when we upgrade?”

REBUTTAL

“Current stable Odoo Enterprise at project start — you get the newest analytic and quality tooling and the longest runway before a forced upgrade — hosted on Odoo.sh, which is the only tier where our change-control commitments are mechanically true. Upgrades then run on a controlled cadence: each release candidate lands on a staging branch against a copy of your production data, the regression suite in the validation plan runs, and only a passed candidate is promoted. You're never surprised by a version change, and you're never stranded on an unsupported one.”

10 · CEO — WHAT DOES THIS COST TO RUN?

“Licenses, hosting, your fees — what does this actually cost me per year? Ballpark.”

REBUTTAL — KNOW THE PUBLIC PRICE SHAPE; NEVER INVENT THE FIRM'S FEE

“Two of the three are public arithmetic: Odoo Enterprise licenses per user per year, and Odoo.sh hosting scaled to workers and storage — for an organization your size that's a defined, budgetable number we'd fix in discovery once we count real users per department, and it's typically a fraction of the legacy per-module licensing you're paying across four systems today. Our own fees are fixed per phase — starting with the fixed-fee discovery sprint in the ask — so the number you approve is the number you pay. What I won't do is quote a total in this room before we've counted your users; that number would be theatre, not budget.”

11 · CIO — WHAT HAPPENS TO THE LIMS?

“You've told me the QMS processes move into Odoo. What happens to the LIMS after go-live — replaced or kept?”

REBUTTAL

“Our working position: quality process workflows — checks, holds, releases, CAPAs — consolidate into Odoo Quality, because that's where the process thread lives. Laboratory instrumentation data capture is a different animal: LIMS platforms do that well, and ripping one out to rebuild instrument interfaces in an ERP is rarely the right trade. So the default is integrate, not replace — lab results flow into the quality check record that gates the lot — and discovery confirms whether your LIMS usage actually justifies keeping it. Either way it's a named decision with an owner, not a system left in limbo.”

12 · CEO — HOW LONG, AND HOW MANY OF MY PEOPLE?

“End to end, how long does this take, and how much of my team's time do you need?”

REBUTTAL

“The discovery sprint is three weeks, fixed. From there, the honest shape for a scope like this is phased quarters, not a multi-year program: configuration sprints per module pair, validation running alongside, go-live module by module rather than big-bang. From your side, the critical resource is two named process owners per department at roughly a day a week during their module's sprint — their job is decisions, not data entry. I'll commit to an exact timeline at the end of discovery, when it's a plan, not a guess — that's the same discipline as the fee.”

13 · CIO — WHERE DOES THE TEMPERATURE DATA COME FROM?

“You show cold-chain limits on the lot record. Who's actually writing temperature readings into the system?”

REBUTTAL

“The lot carries the tolerance envelope; the readings come from an integration we scope in discovery — either import from the data loggers already travelling with your cold-chain shipments, or a live feed from location sensors through Odoo's IoT integration. The envelope fields are configuration; the evidence capture is a named integration workstream, and I'd rather cost that honestly than imply two float fields monitor your warehouse.”

DELIVERY DISCIPLINE

Do not rush to fill silence after a hard question. Pause, then answer. The Annex 11 objection frequently arrives out of sequence — often during the mid-deck technical slides. Being asked early is not a deviation from plan; the answer holds regardless of when it lands. If challenged on the native-versus-extension split, lean into it rather than defend it — naming the extension layer precisely is what separates this pitch from a generic Odoo capability recitation. If a technical panel asks for the exact field or logic driving payer settlement order, “we’d design that in discovery” is the honest answer — don’t invent a field name on the spot to sound more finished than the design actually is.